



More Library Views

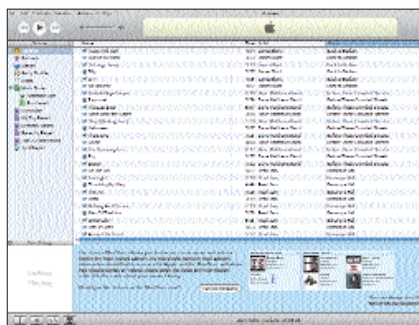
The Library view in WMP 11 has been simplified over its version 10 avatar, but you can get those back with



Get more views under the Library

just two clicks—in the Library view, right-click on Library in the navigation pane and select “Show More Views”. Voila! More categories under the Library.

iTUNES



Playlists With Brains

One of iTunes' best yet surprisingly under-used features is the Smart Playlist, that lets you specify criteria for iTunes to build playlists—much like WMP's “Music Listened To On The Weekend” and so on. To start

creating a new smart playlist, press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [N]. You can now specify songs filtered by Artist names, when you last heard them, genre and beats per minute, to name a few. Also make sure that Live updating is selected, because this will ensure that any new songs that you add to your library will automatically be considered for the playlist.



Back Up Your Collection

With version 7, iTunes lets you easily backup your music collection—you can find its backup utility under **File > Backup To Disk**. It lets you back up your entire collection including playlists, or just backup songs that weren't backed up the last time. And as with all other iTunes features, it's simple as can be.



Use The Shortcuts

WMP 11's keyboard shortcuts aren't exactly the most intuitive, but they can help you get things done fast. Here they are:

Function	Shortcut
Zoom to 50%	[Alt] + [1]
Zoom at 100%	[Alt] + [2]
Zoom to 200%	[Alt] + [3]
Toggle display for full-screen video	[Alt] + [Enter]
Retrace your steps back through your most recent views in the Player	[Alt] + [Left Arrow]
Retrace your steps forward through your most recent views in the Player	[Alt] + [Right Arrow]
Switch to full-screen mode	[Ctrl] + [1]
Switch to skin mode	[Ctrl] + [2]
Turn shuffle on or off	[Ctrl] + [H]
Eject CD or DVD	[Ctrl] + [J]
In full mode, show or hide the Classic Menus (menu bar)	[Ctrl] + [M]
Create a new playlist	[Ctrl] + [N]
Open a file	[Ctrl] + [O]
Play or pause playing	[Ctrl] + [P]
Stop playing	[Ctrl] + [S]
In audio playback, turn repeat on or off	[Ctrl] + [T]
Specify a URL or path to a file	[Ctrl] + [U]
Close or stop playing a file	[Ctrl] + [W]
Rewind video	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [B]
Turn captions and subtitles on or off	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [C]
Fast forward through video or music	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F]
Use a fast play speed	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [G]
Play at normal speed	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [N]
Use a slow play speed	[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [S]
Return to full mode from full screen	[Esc]
Edit media information on a selected item in the library	[F2]
Add media files to the library	[F3]
Refresh information in the panes	[F5]
Mute volume	[F8]
Decrease volume	[F9]
Increase volume	[F10]



Keep Updating Your Library

For whatever reason, iTunes lacks the ability to monitor one or more folders for new music—perhaps Apple assumed that we'd be getting music only from the iTunes Music Store. Thankfully, using a little tool called the iTunes Library Updater (<http://itlu.ownz.ch>), you can work around this flaw. It gives you a simple GUI where you can select which folders your music is in, and automatically update your iTunes library.

You'll need the .NET Framework 2.0 for iTunes Library Updater to work; find it on this month's *Utilities* CD.



Prevent Automatic Syncing With iPod

Imagine going over to a friend's place with your iPod, connecting it to his/her computer and firing up iTunes, only to see that your 'pod's been wiped clean! This could happen if your friend's iTunes is set to automatically sync with the iPod connected to it. To avoid this, hold down [Ctrl] + [Shift] from the moment you connect your iPod to the time that it appears in iTunes. Your collection will remain safe.



No Pod, No Helper

If you don't own an iPod, it's pointless to have the iTunes services (iPodService and iTunesHelper) running in the background—disable iPodService using the services console (**Start > Run > “services.msc” > [Enter]**). Double-click on the service name, and select Disabled under Startup Type. To disable the iTunesHelper, go to **Start > Run > “msconfig” > [Enter]** and uncheck iTunesHelper under the Startup tab.